

A16 THE SAULT STAR — THURSDAY, APRIL 19, 1984

World Turmoil

Gemayel on way to summit

BEIRUT (Reuters) — Lebanese President Amin Gemayel left today for a long-awaited meeting in Damascus with Syrian President Hafez Assad as plans went forward to disengage forces on the front line in and around Beirut.

Gemayel flew with a delegation, including Foreign Minister Elie Salem and two other key advisers who have negotiated with the Syrians and opposition leaders, a presidential palace source said.

As a first step to a disengagement, 80 French and Lebanese ceasefire observers were to take up lock-out positions along the so-called Green Line dividing Christian from Muslim sectors of the capital.

On the eve of the long-awaited summit, residential areas in the Christian east of the city were bombarded for more than four hours and newspapers said about 25 people were wounded.

10 Kurds sentenced to die

ANKARA (Reuters) — A Turkish military court sentenced 10 Kurdish militants to death and 176 to long jail terms Wednesday in the latest in a series of mass trials of ethnic Kurds accused of waging violent separatist campaigns.

The court at Diyarbakir, the southeastern city in the centre of the area where most of Turkey's eight million Kurds live, first condemned 29 of the 363 accused to die. The semi-official Anatolian news agency reported.

However, 19 death sentences were commuted to prison terms because the defendants were minors or not considered dangerous.

Two of the accused, all alleged members of the separatist Kurdistan Workers party, were sentenced to life in prison, six to 25 years, and 149 to up to 20 years. Fourteen cases were held over and the rest of the accused were acquitted.

Bomb blasts Namibia office

WINDHOEK, Namibia (AP) — A bomb explosion destroyed a government office early today in the same town where two U.S. diplomats were killed in a blast five days ago, and another bomb tore through an office 32 kilometres away, authorities said.

There were no casualties in today's explosion in Ohahawini, 40 kilometres south of the Angolan border, said Frans Viljoen, secretary of the local government administration board.

Guerillas of the South West Africa Peoples Organization have waged a prolonged sabotage war against South African rule in the territory, also known as South-West Africa.

Funeral leads to rampage

NEW DELHI (Reuters) — India's security forces today patrolled the streets of the predominantly Sikh Punjab state capital Chandigarh, which was placed under night curfew following rioting by opposition Hindus.

Violence broke out Wednesday when Hindus taking part in a funeral procession for one of their leaders killed by Sikh extremists Tuesday went on the rampage.

The rioting coincided with the arrest of two Pakistani pilots in Punjab, where sectarian Sikh-Hindu strife has claimed at least 130 lives in the last six months.

Sri Lankan violence kills 50

JAFFNA, Sri Lanka (Reuters) — Sri Lankan government officials said Wednesday that more than 50 people were killed in the latest unrest among the Tamil minority, but unofficial estimates put the death toll at more than 200.

Devanathan Noolah, government agent for the country's northern Jaffna district, told Reuters news agency that more than 50 people were shot dead by soldiers in the provincial capital last week.

Sri Lankan officials said earlier that 32 people were killed in skirmishes between troops and separatist guerrillas who attacked a school, a Buddhist temple and a police station in the town.

Political rallies banned in Brazil

BRASILIA (AP) — Brazil's military regime has invoked emergency powers allowing it to ban rallies in the capital, saying militant protesters were coming to intimidate legislators debating whether to hold direct presidential elections this year.

The measures invoked Wednesday night by President Gen. Joao Figueiredo, which affect Brasilia and 10 surrounding counties, suspend the right of public assembly. They also allow for detentions and house searches without warrants, government takeover of unions, censorship of radio and television and control of state-run companies.

Brazilians demanding that the government directly elect Figueiredo's successor have rallied recently in huge numbers. A demonstration in Rio de Janeiro last week drew one million people, in Sao Paulo as many as 1.3 million marched through the streets Monday evening.

The Federal District, home for about 1.4 million people in and around Brasilia, was quiet Wednesday night. There were no signs of increased police or military patrols.

Figueiredo is due to step down in March. Under the current system,

U.S. senators survive as 'copter shot down

TEGUCIGALPA, Honduras (AP) — A U.S. army helicopter was struck by gunfire and forced down Wednesday in Honduras near the El Salvador border.

U.S. officials said. No one was reported injured.

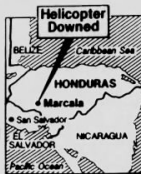
One of the senators, J. Bennett Johnston (D-La.) said the UH-1 helicopter carrying him and Senator Lawton Chiles (D-Fla.) was struck three times by 50-calibre ammunition that came "presumably from Salvadoran guerrillas."

A second UH-1, carrying Diana Negroponte, wife of U.S. Ambassador John Negroponte, also was fired on, but was not hit, said U.S. Embassy officials in the Honduran capital. No injuries were reported in that aircraft, either.

The mountainous area where the helicopters were fired on is 100 kilometres west of this capital city and 19 kilometres from the Salvadoran border province of Morazan, a longtime stronghold of leftist guerrillas who are fighting the U.S.-supported government in El Salvador.

The senators, on a fact-finding mission in Honduras, were on their way from a Honduran air force base to a United Nations-operated camp for Salvadoran refugees in southwestern Honduras.

Many residents of the camp, Colomangua, are considered sympathetic to the Salvadoran guerrillas.



A report from San Salvador today says leftist rebels staged simultaneous attacks on four towns in northeast El Salvador near the area where the helicopter carrying the two senators was struck by gunfire and forced to land in Honduras.

Five Salvadoran soldiers were killed, nine were wounded and at least seven guerrillas died in the fighting. Wednesday in Morazan province, military sources in the area said. Two civilians also were killed.

In Nicaragua, rebels fighting the leftist Sandinista government attacked a Misquito Indian town in the northeast, killing four civilians and one government soldier, the official newspaper Baricada said Wednesday. It said 14 people were wounded and 32 kidnapped.

Of the clashes between Salvadoran rebels and government troops Wednesday in Morazan, the heaviest fighting was at Joco, said Col. Jorge Alberto Cruz, army commander in Morazan.

The fighting continued into the night as the army tried to recover heights seized by the rebels from a company of 180 government troops early Wednesday.

Guerrillas attacked Joco, 160 kilometres northeast of San Salvador, early Wednesday, simultaneously attacking the towns of El Divisadero, Ocasal and Guatijagua. They also attacked Chapeltique, 160 kilometres northeast of San Salvador in San Miguel province, which borders Morazan.

Earlier in the day, rebels were massing west of San Francisco Gotera, 145 kilometres northeast of San Salvador, and at Soledad, northeast of Joco, Cruz said.

The rebel moves appeared aimed at taking the provincial capital, which lies roughly between the two concentrations of rebels. But Cruz said they had reinforced the base at San Francisco Gotera and doubted the rebels would try to take the city without the element of surprise in their favor.

Army troops continued a three-day old counterinsurgency operation in northern San Vicente province following an increase in rebel attacks in the area.

Woman rejected as ambassador

WASHINGTON (AP) — A heroine of the Sandinista revolution in Nicaragua who helped kill a general there has been rejected by the Reagan administration as the next Nicaraguan ambassador to Washington.

Nora Astorga, a twice-married mother of four who is in her late 30s, has freely admitted her role as an accomplice in the March 8, 1978, bedroom slaying of Gen. Reynaldo Perez Vega, the deputy commander of the National Guard.

In confirming her rejection by Washington, a U.S. official, who asked not to be identified, said the administration felt Astorga would not be an appropriate envoy in view of the 1978 incident.

A veteran Sandinista who has a law degree and has studied in the United States and Italy, Astorga has publicly discussed the events leading up to the slaying of Perez Vega who, unconfirmed reports say, had been a CIA informer.

The original plan, Astorga has said, was to kidnap Perez Vega and exchange him for 59 prisoners, including Tomas Berge, now interior minister. Daniel Ortega, coordinator of the governing Sandinista junta, and Lenin Cerna, head of state security.

Thank You

The Korah West No. 19 Club Pack express their appreciation to the following for their help and donations, during the District Kuba Kar Rally held on April 8.

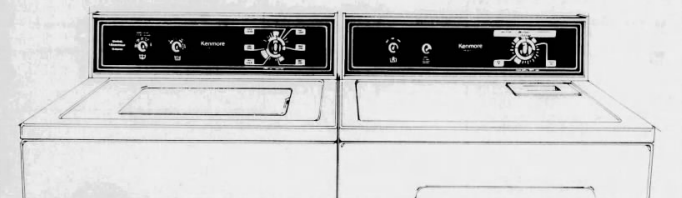
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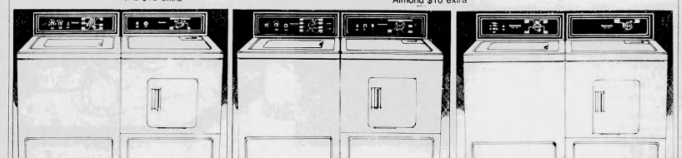
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